

Bedtime Tales

Lulu the Ladybug's Missing Spot

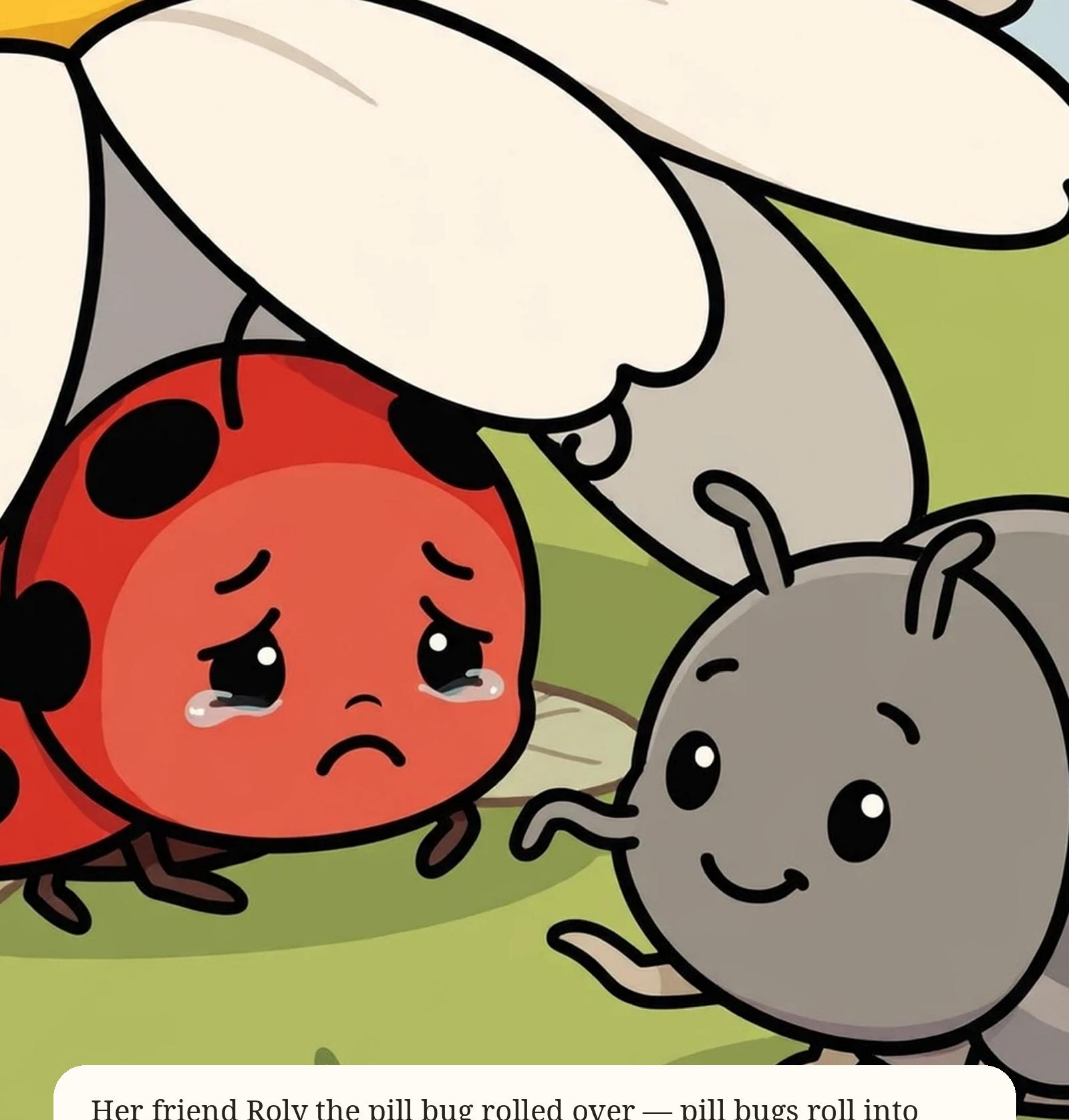


KIDS BOOK VIDEOS

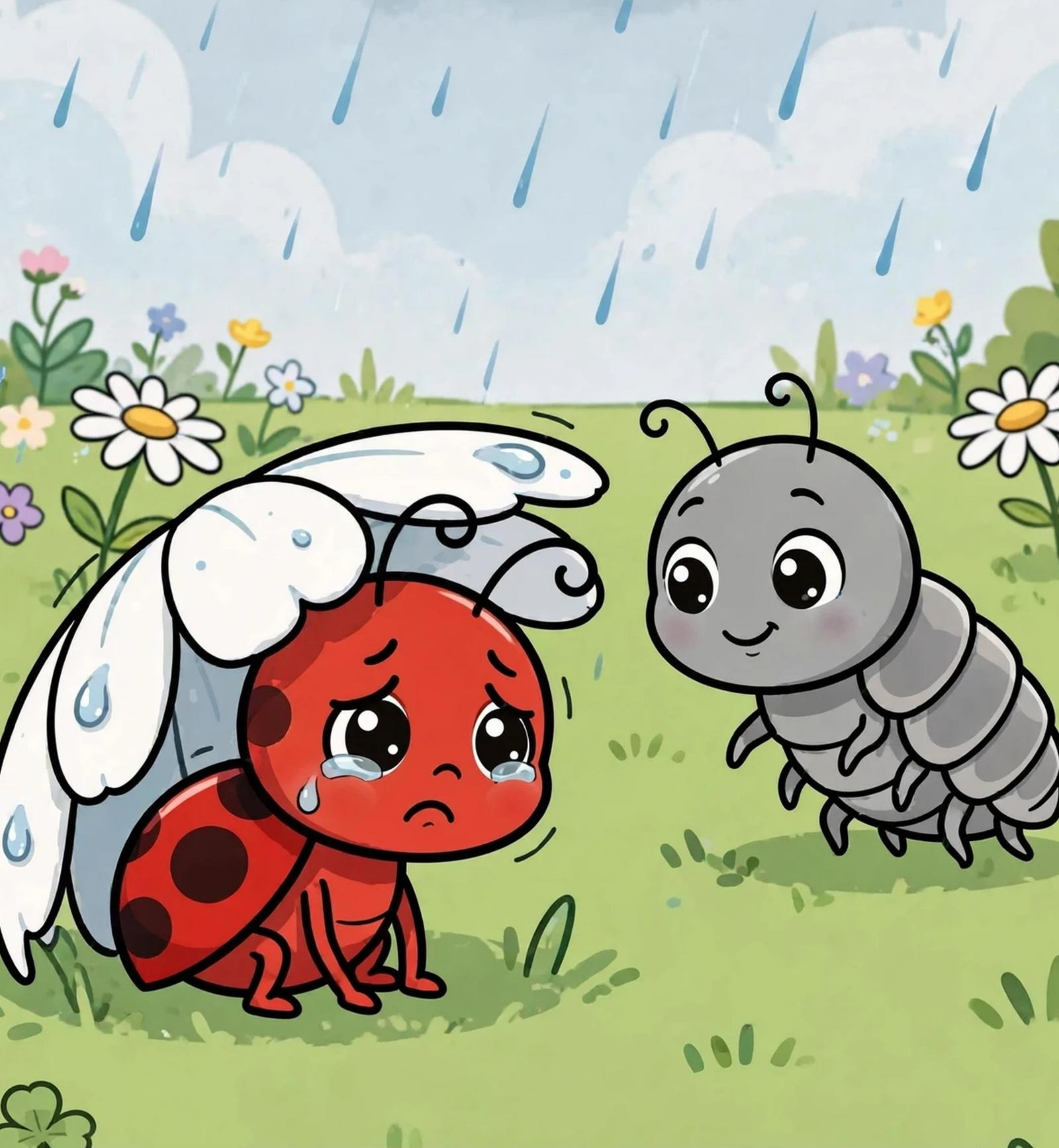


Lulu was a tiny red ladybug who lived on a daisy in the Dream Garden. She had seven black spots, and she counted them every morning. One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. Her spots were her pride.

One rainy morning, Lulu woke up and counted her spots. One, two, three, four, five, six. Six! One spot was missing! Lulu gasped and looked all over the daisy. No spot. Her wings trembled. "I am not a proper ladybug!" she cried, hiding under a petal, feeling sad.



Her friend Roly the pill bug rolled over — pill bugs roll into balls, and Roly was very good at rolling. "Why are you hiding, Lulu?" he asked.



"I lost a spot," sniffed Lulu. "Now I only have six."



Roly unrolled and looked. "You are still Lulu," he said. "You are perfect, spots and all."



"You are perfect, spots and all." Lulu repeated it softly. "You are perfect, spots and all." It became her comforting words. "You are perfect, spots and all."



Roly had a sweet idea. "Let us paint a new spot," he said. "With berry juice!" They found a ripe blackberry. Squelch! Roly dabbed the juice with a grass blade and carefully painted a round spot. Pat pat pat. Lulu looked at her reflection in a dewdrop. Seven spots again! One, two, three, four, five, six, seven. Lulu giggled. "It tickles!" she said. Her friend had helped her feel whole, and she felt happy and loved.



Can you count Lulu's spots? One, two, three, four, five, six, seven! Now count them backwards: seven, six, five...



Then it started to rain again. Pitter patter. Oh no! The berry-judge spot began to wash away. Drip drip. Lulu watched it fade — but she did not cry. "You are perfect, spots and all," she said. Six spots or seven. She was still Lulu. Roly smiled. "That is the bravest thing," he said. They danced in the rain, six spots shining.



When the rain stopped, a rainbow appeared. Lulu rested on the daisy while Roly curled under a leaf. "Goodnight, perfect ladybug," whispered Roly. "Goodnight," yawned Lulu. She counted her spots one last time. Six, and that was fine. The garden smelled fresh and sweet, the petals rocked gently, and Lulu slept, perfect, spots and all.



Sleep now, little Lulu.

Sleep now, little Lulu.

The End

